

ground color and images', and click OK. Now, you will be able to print a Web page with its background images and colours.

If you use Netscape, go to **File > Page Setup**. Under 'Format & Options', you will see a check box labelled 'Print Background (colors & images)'. Tick this, and click OK. Now go to **File > Print** and click Print.

Fun with your printer

Creating monthly calendars

Most word processing applications come with specific methods to create calendars. In MS Word, you can find it by going to **Insert > 'Object...'**, and then choosing 'Calendar Control.' But this might not provide the level of customisation that you want in order to mark certain important occasions, like your anniversary. An easy solution is available at <http://www.timeanddate.com/calendar/>. This Web site has calendars customised for many countries, which you could use as your template. Copy the calendar pertaining to the months you wish to



You can print the Outlook calendar with all notes and meetings reminders

print, into your word processing or image-editing program, customise it and then print them.

Another way is



to use specialised software such as Calendar 200X, which can be downloaded from www.graffman.net. You can also use Outlook to print a calendar. Just switch to calendar, and go to **File > 'Print...'**. You will be presented with a dialog box, asking you to choose the printing style. You can print weekly or monthly views of your calendar, with your appointments marked out.

Creating a personalised mouse-pad

You can create a personalised mouse pad, using a 3mm thick foam sheet, double-sided adhesive sheets, inkjet coated-satin finish fabric, coated paper, glossy-finish acrylic spray, and a pair of scissors. First, choose a design that you can print on coated inkjet paper. If you are satisfied with the results, take a final printout on the satin-finish fabric. Allow the ink to dry completely. Then,

spray it with acrylic, and leave it to dry again. Peel away the covering from

one side of the adhesive, and apply it to the flipside of the fabric. Cut out

the design, and remove the other covering of the adhesive. Now, paste it on the foam

sheet. Cut out the foam sheet in the shape of

the design, and your mouse pad is ready!

Card modelling

Card modelling is the art of creating a scaled model with card paper. This is somewhat similar to Origami—the craft of folding paper. You can use your printer to print ready-made kits, available on some Web sites, or create them yourself from scratch. Here are a few Web sites that will help you get started: www.fiddlersgreen.net, www.digitalnavy.com, www.paperparadise.com and www.cardfaq.org/faq. All you need in order to create these paper models is a computer, printer, scissors, glue and good quality printing paper.

Computerless printing

Thus far, you've needed a computer to act as an interface between your digital camera and your printer. Now, with newer cameras and printers, you can print

photographs from digital cameras without a PC! Some of the latest printers provide you with a special slot for the memory card of your digital camera. You can download your pictures to the printer, preview them on the printer's LCD, choose the ones that you want printed, make adjustments, and then print them. HP has come up with its Photosmart series of cameras and printers, which provide you with this functionality.

Some printers do not require a memory card to be inserted; the camera is directly attached to the printer via a cable. Canon's Powershot series is one such example. You can customise photographs by using the camera controls and the LCD, and print directly to the printer.

Page setup

Most of the printing software provide you with a 'Page Setup' feature. This lets you determine how your page is going to print. The first thing that you can set is margin. The margin is the distance of the printed material from the edge of the paper. If you were printing formal documents, you would prefer larger margins—especially the left margin. Otherwise, you can opt for smaller margins. Remember that you cannot set the margins to be zero—most applications are smart enough to warn you if you try to do so.

The next customisable thing is the gutter. The gutter identifies a blank space on